

UNION GENERAL (1815-72)

GEORGE GORDON MEADE

Born in Spain of American parents, Meade was a career army officer who had worked as an engineer and seen action against the Seminole Indians and in the War with Mexico of 1846-48. He served in the Army of the Potomac from the start of the Civil War. With the temper and appearance of an "old googly-eyed snapping turtle," he had the character and tactical skill to beat Lee at Gettysburg, but he was criticized for failing to follow up Lee's retreating army in the aftermath. Meade stayed in command of the Army of the Potomac until the end of the war, although in the final campaigns he fought under the close supervision of Ulysses S. Grant, the Union general-in-chief.

